

Annihilation and switchback

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Chess problem composition at the highest level requires certain basic tenets such as vision, flair and constructional finesse to name a few. The foreplan of attack which forms part of strategic content of a more-mover needs vision of an exceptional variety as in the problem for study this week. Generally annihilation, the elimination of a white piece in the process of solution and switchback go together and the problem below exhibits the profundity of this combination. The white rook in this case is cruelly sacrificed, rather annihilated because it comes in the way of the white bishop's eventual mate at e3. The only defence and the only escape for black is the flight at e5, and it is after black king's move black is persuaded to annihilate WRe3 in a surprise offer which black is unable to refuse. Black bishop by accepting the offer keeps the WK off control of g3.

Rolf Tautner

I prize, Schach Aktiv 1995



Mate in six moves

1.Ne1!!(2.Nf3),Ke5(1...Bany 2.Bxd6) 2.Kf2!!(3.Nf3+Kf4 4..Bxg5) Bxe3+(2...h6? 3.Kg3! Kd4 4.Rd3+Ke5 5.Nf3) 3.Ke2!! (4.Nf3+, Kf4 5,Bxd6) Bc5!(3...c5?4.Kxe3)4.Nd3+,Kd4 5.Bxg5 6.Be3.The annihilation is embedded in a logical sequence of foreplan where both white and black

retract to their original squares after the event. There are as many as four successive switchbacks- position sans the troublesome white rook. The mate on e3 is the plan and sacrifice of WR is the preparatory manouvre.

Eugene Fomichev

1 place, Moscow 2012



Mate in four moves

Set; 1...bxc4 2.Qg4+ Kd3 3.Bxc4+Kd2 4.Qe2; 2...Bf4. 3.Qxf5+ Kd3 4.Bxc4

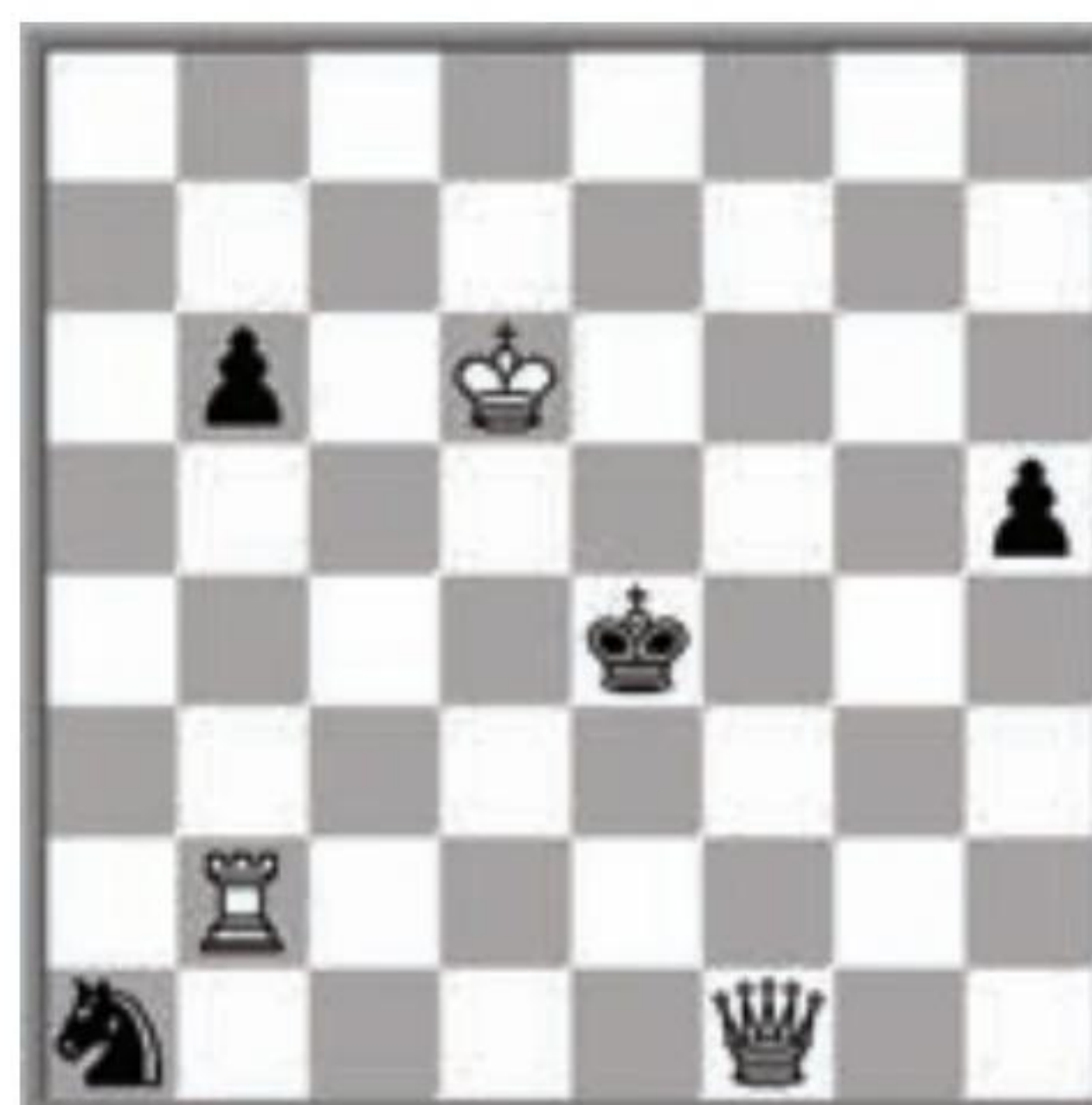
Key 1.Bg4![2.Nc5+ Kxe5 3.Qxe3+ Kxf6/Kd5 4.Nd7/Qe7#(Qf3+? Kd3 3.Nxc5+ Kxc4!, 2.Bf3+? Kf5 3.Qd3+ Kg5!)} 1..bxc4 2.Qf3+ Kd3 3.Nxc5+ Kd2 4.Qe2# 1...g5 2.Bf3+ Kf5 3.Qd3+ Ke6 4.Bg4#

Mating switchbacks & distant self-blocks.

The miniature for solving shows two echos with distant self-blocks

V.Krillov ad V.Ivanov 2011

I Pr, Sem. Shaktimanykh Not



Mate in four moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Black knight in cross-checks':

Key 1.Nf6! (threat 2.Re4);

Readers may send in their queries to cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com